

9

ESOTERIC PYTHON ODDITIES



The systems of rules that define a programming language are complicated and can lead to code that, although not wrong, is quite odd and unexpected.

This chapter dives into the more obscure Python language oddities. You're unlikely to actually run into these cases in real-world coding, but they're interesting uses of the Python syntax (or abuses of it, depending on your perspective).

By studying the examples in this chapter, you'll get a better idea of how Python works under the hood. Let's have a little fun and explore some esoteric gotchas.

Why 256 Is 256 but 257 Is Not 257

The `==` operator compares two objects for equal value, but the `is` operator compares them for equal identity. Although the integer value `42` and the float value `42.0` have the same value, they're two different objects held in